



Virtual keyboard options

Processor and memory

HTC Tattoo is powered by a single Qualcomm MSM 7225 processor, running at a speed of up to 528 MHz. Overall, I haven't experienced any lock-downs, crashes or lags. Moreover, the phone responds very fast to any command, even when multiple applications are running in the background.

Tattoo has 256 MB RAM and a 512 MB ROM memory. The storage space can be expanded up to 16 GB through the hot-swappable microSD card slot that has been placed under the back cover, on the left, lower corner of the phone.

Calls and contacts

The core benefit of any phone is its ease in making calls. In Tattoo's case, it's very easy. On the home screen, just click the Phone tab and you are into your contacts database.

The dial pad is the first thing you will notice when on this screen. This isn't just there to type in full numbers; you can use it as a quick link to the number you want. Simply tap the number with the letter that your contact's name starts with, and it will jump to that section.

This is something that doesn't take too long to get used to. If you do get annoyed with it then just hit the grid button on the bottom left and you will

have full scrolling control on all your contacts. Here, you can scroll through and choose a number. If you don't want to use the touchscreen, then the HTC's four-way navigational button can also be used to scroll down.

Hold down your finger on a contact and you will be able to see what messages have been sent to you by that person and other snippets of information.

The call quality is crisp and clear, and I don't have any complaints about the voice being distant or muffled. Turning up the sound on the flush-set volume rocker on the phone's side did make a difference, but it also added a slight crackle. This didn't happen all the time and could well be blamed on the reception.

As long as you remember to press the *End Call* button on the screen, you shouldn't have a problem ending a phone call. It sounds like an obvious thing, but it's not, as you would instinctively want to press the angry red button on the right, which will put the phone on standby, immediately.

Messaging

Text messaging is definitely an experience here. You have two options when texting people: you can either do it when the phone is in portrait or in landscape mode. I would recommend the latter. My fingertips

aren't the pudgiest, but when I used the phone in portrait, it took a long time to text someone, as I had to constantly correct what I had written.

Touchscreen phones are renowned for being a learning experience for even the most seasoned of texters. And in the case of the Tattoo, it is tougher since the screen is 1.016 cm (0.4 inches) smaller than the Magic and almost 2.5 cm (an inch) smaller than the Hero.

This makes a massive difference when it comes to texting, as even though there is an option to have the full QWERTY in portrait mode, the letters are far too crammed for you to use it properly—unless you have a sniper's aim.

Landscape mode means that letters have a bit more space to breathe and fewer mistakes are made.

The Internet

As with Android phones, the HTC Tattoo is fully equipped to be an Internet browsing device. Getting on to the Web is fairly straightforward—just choose the Browser app and enter the URL.

Web access is fast and loads up pretty quickly, even on the pathetic EDGE connection in Bangalore. And as far as the Wi-Fi network goes, even a paltry 256 Kbps connection is good enough to give you a rich Web experience.